



4–6 mm
5/32–1/4 in

HOUSE FLY
Musca domestica
F: Muscidae

This species is found worldwide and is the most common fly around dwellings, where it transmits a number of disease-causing organisms to foodstuffs.

GRASS FLY
Meromyza pratorum
F: Chloropidae

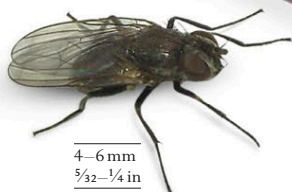
This fly occurs across the northern hemisphere, especially in sandy coastal regions. The larvae burrow in stems of marram grass and reed grass.



6–7 mm
1/4–7/32 in

POECILOBOTHRUS NOBILITATUS
F: Dolichopodidae

This European species can be found in damp habitats near water. Males display in sunny patches by waving their wings.



4–6 mm
5/32–1/4 in

LESSER HOUSE FLY
Fannia canicularis
F: Fanniidae

Able to breed in almost any decaying, semi-liquid matter, this species is particularly associated with human habitation.



3–5 mm
1/8–3/16 in

MOTH FLY
Clogmia albipunctata
F: Psychodidae

This very widespread fly species resembles a tiny moth. The larvae breed in dark, wet places such as drains, tree holes, and sewage.



1.4–1.8 cm
1/2–2/3 in

FLESH FLY
Sarcophaga carnaria
F: Sarcophagidae

Widely distributed through Europe and Asia, this fly feeds on nectar and liquids from rotting matter. The female lays small larvae on carrion.

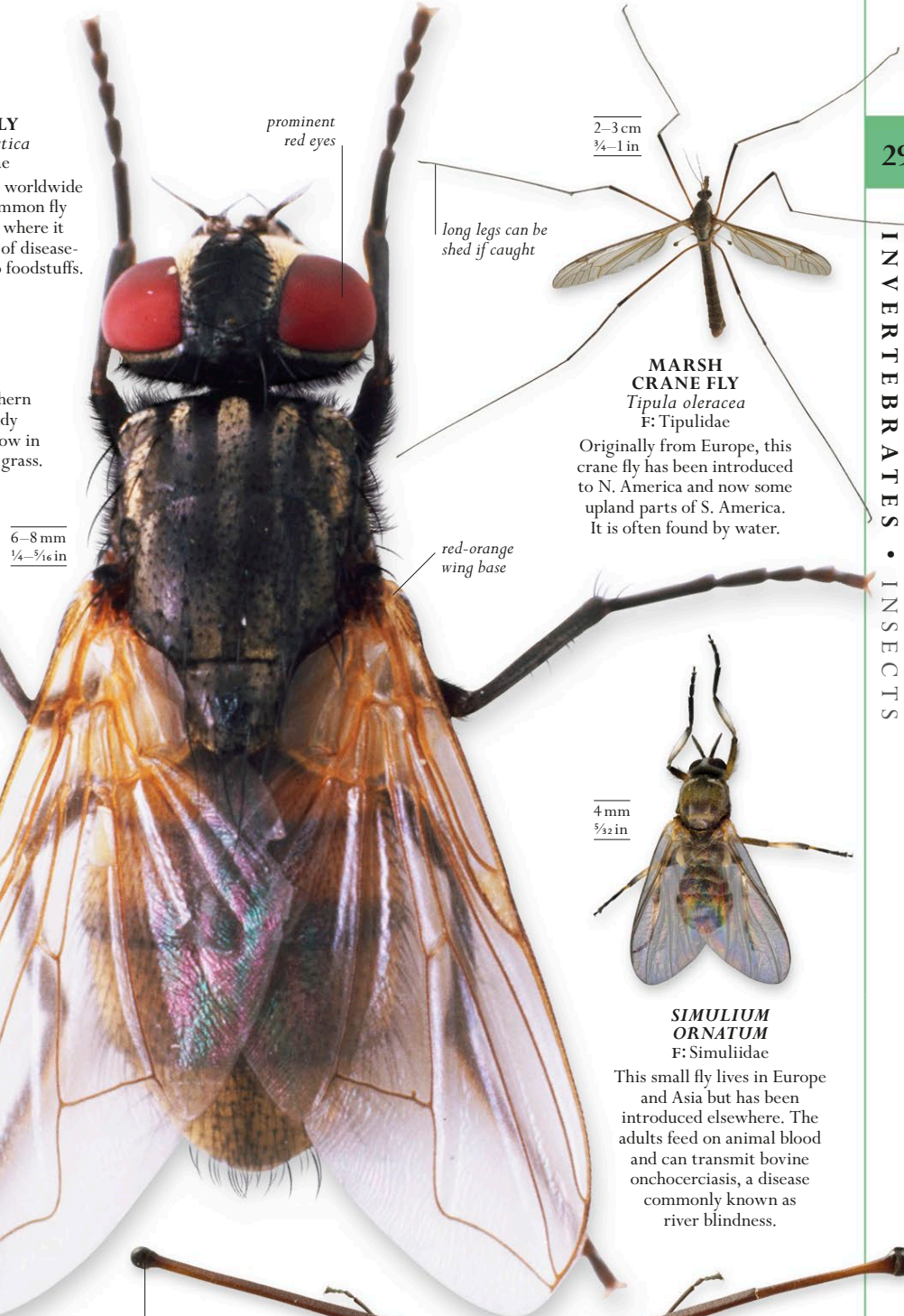


8–14 mm
5/16–1/2 in

FERRUGINOUS BEE-GRABBER
Sicus ferrugineus
F: Conopidae

This European fly lays eggs in the abdomen of certain bumble bees. The larvae develop as internal parasites, killing the host.

pale face with large compound eyes



prominent red eyes

long legs can be shed if caught

red-orange wing base

males with longer eyestalks win fights for territory

ROTHSCHILD'S ACHIAS
Achias rothschildi
F: Platystomatidae

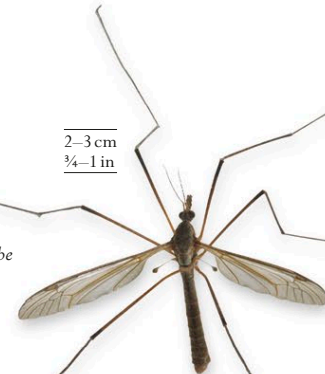
Males of this Papua New Guinean fly have very elongate eyestalks, which are used in territorial and mating displays.



1–2 mm
1/32–1/16 in

FARMYARD MIDGE
Culicoides nubeculosus
F: Ceratopogonidae

This widespread European fly breeds in mud contaminated by dung or sewage. Adults suck the blood of horses and cattle.



2–3 cm
3/4–1 in

MARSH CRANE FLY
Tipula oleracea
F: Tipulidae

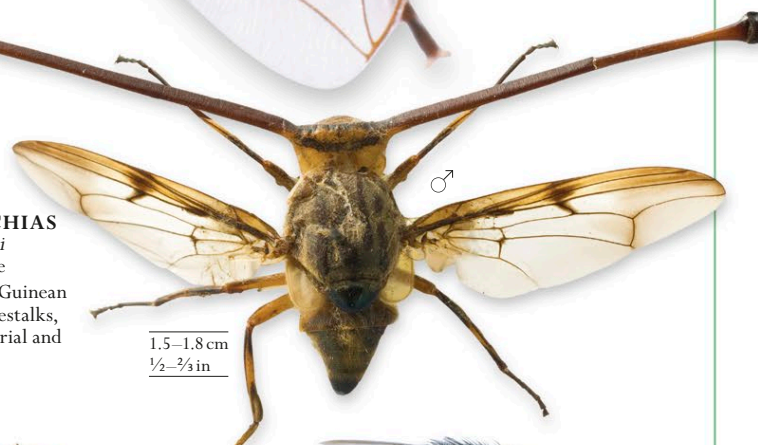
Originally from Europe, this crane fly has been introduced to N. America and now some upland parts of S. America. It is often found by water.



4 mm
5/32 in

SIMULIUM ORNATUM
F: Simuliidae

This small fly lives in Europe and Asia but has been introduced elsewhere. The adults feed on animal blood and can transmit bovine onchocerciasis, a disease commonly known as river blindness.



1.5–1.8 cm
1/2–2/3 in



1–1.2 cm
3/8–1/2 in

BLUEBOTTLE
Calliphora vicina
F: Calliphoridae

Found in Europe and N. America, this species is especially common in urban areas and breeds in dead pigeons and rodents.